

BEYOND THE KINGDOM

Episode #0008

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EST)

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0008

(ages as of Wednesday, January 12, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68) · JOAN DONOHUE (66)

THE OLSONS: CONGRESSWOMAN JASMINE DONOHUE OLSON (44) · DR. PETER OLSON (45) · MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) · GRACE BULLOCK (20)

THE SMILLEYS: LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49) · DESMOND SMILLEY (48) · DELPHINE SMILLEY-ASHE (25) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22) · QUENTIN SMILLEY (21)

THE CUMMINGSES: FRANKLIN CUMMINGS (54) · DR. YVETTE CUMMINGS (51)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22)

THE SEVEN: TOBIAS "THE LEDGER" OKAFOR (24) · KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25) · ROMAN GAINES (28) · DOLORES "MAMA DEE" WHITFIELD (54 today) · RASHAD "SAINT" MAYFIELD (23)

RECURRING: INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (by phone) · CELESTE VAUGHN (24) · SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57) · DEPUTY CHIEF WARREN HUGHES (46) · COUNCILMAN LEON HARDAWAY (43) · THADDEUS CROWE (40) · GORDON ELLIS (36) · LIONEL "LO" PIERCE (39) · RUBY MAE "NANA RUBY" TOLLIVER (66)

DAY PLAYERS: TANISHA (waitress) · DR. RAYMOND HARRINGTON (Lucius's neurologist) · TEDDY MERRIWEATHER (Silas's nephew) · OTIS (Silas's man) · COUNCIL PRESIDENT · RITZ-CARLTON BARTENDER · VELVET BOUNCER · SIMONE'S MAID (CLEO)

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Alvin Donohue (Miami) · Luke Smilley · Odessa Smilley · Kiara Baker · Camille Rhodes · Mimi Henderson

FADE IN:

TEASER

1 EXT. DEE'S KITCHEN – THE BACK DOOR – WEST END – DAWN
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 5:42 AM EST

A narrow alley behind Ralph David Abernathy Boulevard. Dumpsters, a stack of empty produce crates, and a single bulb over a steel door with a hand-painted sign:
DELIVERIES – KNOCK LOUD – MAMA DEE HEARS EVERYTHING.

Cold. Still dark.

MAMA DEE WHITFIELD (54 today), in a wool coat over her white apron, a scarf on her head, unlocks the steel door with a ring of keys the size of a fist. She's been opening this door at 5:45 every morning since 1981.

She stops.

On the concrete step, waiting in the circle of light, is an enormous arrangement of yellow roses. Three dozen. In a heavy crystal vase that costs more than the building's plumbing.

Mama Dee looks up and down the empty alley.

She bends. There's a small white card tucked among the stems. Handwritten in green ink:

INSERT – THE CARD: "Happy birthday, Mama. Eat something first. – A friend."

She reads it. She presses her lips together hard.

MAMA DEE
(to the empty alley,
gruff)
"A friend."
(beat)
Boy, you are going to get
somebody killed with this green
ink.

She wipes her eyes fast with the back of her wrist. She picks up the vase with a grunt.

Headlights sweep into the alley. A black hearse.
MERRIWEATHER & SONS in discreet gold lettering on the door.

Mama Dee freezes, vase in her arms.

The hearse stops. The driver's door opens. OTIS (60s), Silas's oldest man, in a black suit and a chauffeur's cap, gets out. He goes to the back of the hearse, the part where the caskets go, and opens it.

He lifts out a second arrangement. White calla lilies, tall and elegant, in a black lacquered box.

He carries it to the step and holds it out with great formality.

OTIS

Miss Dolores. From Mr.
Merriweather. With his
compliments on the occasion.

MAMA DEE

(staring at the hearse)
He sent it in the HEARSE?

OTIS

(beat, dignified)
It's the only vehicle he trusts
with flowers, ma'am.

Mama Dee sets the roses down. She takes the lilies. There's a card, heavy black stock, with a silver border.

INSERT – THE CARD, in an old man's careful fountain-pen script: "No black lilies. Happy 54th, Dolores. – S.M."

Mama Dee reads it. And then she laughs. A big, helpless, early-morning laugh that bounces off the dumpsters.

MAMA DEE

That old fool.

OTIS

Shall I tell him you said so?

MAMA DEE

(still laughing, wiping
her eyes)
Tell him I said thank you. Tell
him he's still an old fool. Tell
him both, Otis, and tell him in
that order.

OTIS

(tipping his cap)
Yes, ma'am.

He gets back in the hearse. It backs out of the alley as solemnly as it came.

Mama Dee stands on her back step at dawn on her fifty-fourth birthday with yellow roses at her feet and white lilies in her arms.

She looks at the two cards. One in green ink. One in silver.

MAMA DEE (CONT'D)
(to herself)
Two men who don't know how to say
anything plain.

She carries the lilies inside. Then she comes back for the roses.

CUT TO:

2 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR – MORNING
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 7:53 AM EST

Simone at her round table in the pale-yellow parlor, in a dove-gray dressing gown and her everyday pearls. Coffee. One soft-boiled egg in a silver cup. The Sentinel folded to Bernadette's column.

CLEO (60s), Simone's maid for thirty years, in a starched gray uniform, enters with a small silver tray. On it, a single cream envelope.

CLEO
Madame. This came to the kitchen door at a quarter to eight. By hand. A young man in a Smilley coat. He wouldn't come in and he wouldn't wait.

SIMONE
(not looking up from the paper)
Of course he wouldn't.

CLEO
It's addressed to you, Madame.
"Mrs. Alexander J. Donohue."

Simone sets the paper down. She takes the envelope from the tray. She looks at the handwriting on the front for a long moment.

SIMONE
(quietly)
Thank you, Cleo.

Cleo goes. Simone takes a silver letter opener from beside her plate. She slits the envelope cleanly and slides out the single folded sheet. E.O.S.

She reads it.

Her face doesn't move.

She reads it again.

On the second reading, at one particular line, the corner of her mouth lifts.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
(reading aloud, softly)
"It wasn't a lack of respect. It
was the opposite."

She sets the letter on the table. She smooths it flat with her palm.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
(to the empty room)
Odessa, you old snake.
(beat)
You raised a good one.

She rises from the table, slowly, with the help of her ivory-handled cane. She crosses to a small rosewood secretary desk in the corner.

She unlocks the top drawer with a tiny key from her pocket. Inside, a small stack of old letters tied with a faded blue ribbon. On top, an envelope yellowed with age, a Savannah postmark, and a three-cent stamp: MARCH 1952.

She doesn't untie the ribbon. She lays Esther's letter gently on top of the old one.

She looks at the two envelopes together.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
(barely audible)
Not yet.

She closes the drawer. She locks it.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES – "KINGDOM"

ACT ONE**3 INT. BELLE RIVE – THE MASTER SUITE – MORNING**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 8:04 AM EST

The silk-walled bedroom. Morning sun. Natasha sits at her vanity in a robe, putting on diamond studs.

Robert comes out of the bathroom already dressed in a navy suit, holding two cups of coffee. He sets one down on the vanity beside her. Two sugars, a splash of cream. Exactly right.

NATASHA
(looking at it in the
mirror)
You made my coffee.

ROBERT
I've made your coffee for
twenty-three years.

NATASHA
Ruby's made my coffee for
twenty-three years. You've
carried it upstairs twice.

ROBERT
(smiling)
Then this is three.

She picks it up. She sips. It's perfect. She looks at him in the mirror.

NATASHA
What's on your calendar this
week?

ROBERT
Hendricks. The Morehouse board
Thursday afternoon. The usual.

NATASHA
Thursday night?

A tiny beat. Robert adjusts his cufflink.

ROBERT
Probably late. Hendricks is a
monster.

NATASHA
(pleasantly)
You're always late on Thursdays.

ROBERT
Am I?

NATASHA
Since about 1999.

He meets her eyes in the mirror. She holds them, perfectly pleasant.

ROBERT
(evenly)
Thursday's the day the week
catches up with you.

NATASHA
(beat, smiling)
Isn't it.

She goes back to her earrings. He kisses the top of her head.

ROBERT
Love you.

NATASHA
(to the mirror)
I know you do.

He goes. The door closes.

Natasha sets down the coffee. She opens the drawer of her vanity, takes out a small leather datebook, and turns to January.

She writes on Thursday, January 13, in small, neat letters: "R. - late."

She closes the book.

CUT TO:

**4 INT. THE CUMMINGS ESTATE - 41 KINGSRIDGE DRIVE - THE
BREAKFAST ROOM - MORNING**
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 - 8:22 AM EST

A sunny breakfast room in a big Tudor house: chintz, a round table, a view of the garden and the white gazebo. Three places set.

FRANKLIN CUMMINGS (54), media mogul, in a cardigan over a dress shirt, reads the Wall Street Journal. DR. YVETTE CUMMINGS (51), cardiologist, in a silk blouse and a white coat hung on the back of her chair, butters toast with surgical precision.

Arianna comes in, dressed for court in black, grabbing a banana from the fruit bowl without sitting down.

ARIANNA

Morning.

FRANKLIN

(not looking up)

Morning, Madam District Attorney.

YVETTE

Sit down.

ARIANNA

I've got a nine-thirty.

YVETTE

(pleasantly, still
buttering)

Sit down, Arianna.

Arianna sits. Franklin lowers his paper an inch, sensing weather.

YVETTE (CONT'D)

Mimi Henderson called me last night.

Arianna peels the banana very carefully.

YVETTE (CONT'D)

She got your letter. On District Attorney letterhead. Asking for the guest list from her New Year's party. 2001.

(beat)

She wanted to know why her goddaughter's office is asking her who came to her house three years ago.

ARIANNA

It's not my letter, Mama. It's a cold-case investigator's letter. It went to forty houses.

YVETTE

It has your signature on it.

ARIANNA

Everything in that office has my signature on it.

FRANKLIN

(mildly)

What's the case?

ARIANNA

(beat)

A young man went missing that night. Walking home from a party on the 3100 block. His family's been looking for three years.

FRANKLIN

The Divine boy. The sister's the one who just got the Smilley account.

ARIANNA

Yes.

FRANKLIN

(going back to his paper)

Good for you, reopening it. That family's been failed.

Yvette hasn't taken her eyes off her daughter.

YVETTE

You told me you had the flu that night.

Arianna stops peeling.

YVETTE (CONT'D)

You called me at 2:15 in the morning, from the Hendersons' powder room, and said you were sick and you were driving yourself home.

(beat)

And the next morning you were in bed with the covers over your head, and you didn't come out for four days. And your car was gone.

FRANKLIN
(lowering the paper
again)
Yvette.

YVETTE
Your car was "in the shop," you
said. And then Marc-Anthony
bought you a new one for your
birthday, ten months early.

ARIANNA
(evenly)
Mama. I was nineteen. I'd had
champagne. I got sick. I didn't
want you to see me like that.

YVETTE
You've never cried since. Not at
your grandmother's funeral. Not
when you passed the bar. Not at
your swearing-in.

ARIANNA
(standing)
I'm going to be late.

YVETTE
Arianna.

ARIANNA
(at the door, not
turning)
I had the flu, Mama.

She goes. The front door closes a moment later.

Franklin folds his paper. He looks at his wife.

FRANKLIN
What was that?

YVETTE
(beat, very quietly)
I'm a cardiologist, Franklin. I
know what a broken heart looks
like on a scan.
(beat)
I've been looking at one across
this table for three years.

She sets down the butter knife. Her hand isn't quite
steady.

CUT TO:

5 EXT. AUBURN AVENUE – THE 400 BLOCK – "SWEET AUBURN" – DAY*Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 9:26 AM EST*

The historic heart of Black Atlanta, faded. Boarded storefronts. A shuttered theater marquee. Empty lots behind chain-link fences. Martin Luther King Jr.'s birth home a few blocks east; Ebenezer's steeple in the distance.

And at the corner of the block, six stories of red brick and limestone with arched windows, and carved in stone over the entrance: HOTEL DONOHUE – 1936. The doors are chained. The ground-floor windows are papered over.

Esther and Harmony walk up the sidewalk side by side, in flats and wool coats: Esther in camel, Harmony in black, with a clipboard and a Keel & Associates plat map.

HARMONY
(reading from the
clipboard)

The city owns the three lots on the south side, from the old tax sale in '96. The church on the corner owns two. The rest are held by three estates. One of the heirs lives in Detroit. One's in prison. One's dead, and his heirs are fighting over it in probate.

ESTHER
(looking at the hotel)
And that?

HARMONY
(following her gaze)
Hotel Donohue. Opened 1936 by Alexander Donohue. Closed for years. It's owned by Donohue Global Holdings. Not for sale.
(beat)
It's never been for sale. Keel's tried twice.

Esther stops walking. She looks up at the red brick, the arched windows, and the carved stone.

ESTHER

My grandfather Cornelius used to
stand right here and look at it.

(beat)

Daddy says he died still looking
at it.

HARMONY

Your family is so weird.

ESTHER

Your family has a MARTA route
named after it.

HARMONY

My daddy DRIVES a MARTA route,
Esther. That's not the same
thing.

Esther smiles. She keeps looking at the hotel. Harmony
watches her.

HARMONY (CONT'D)

(carefully)

Why are we here?

ESTHER

(beat)

Because next week the mayor is
going to announce the biggest
redevelopment in the history of
this city. Right here. Twelve
blocks of Sweet Auburn.

(beat)

And everybody on this street is
going to be bidding for it.
Including the family that owns
that hotel.

HARMONY

(stunned)

How do you know that?

ESTHER

(walking again)

I'm a Smilley. We know things.

They walk past the hotel's side alley.

Esther glances down it. And stops.

Halfway down the alley, parked beside a steel side door,
is a silver ASTON MARTIN DB9.

She stands very still.

HARMONY
What?

ESTHER
(beat)
Nothing.

HARMONY
You look like you saw a ghost.

ESTHER
(turning away, walking
faster)
It's cold. Let's go. I want to
see the south lots.

She walks briskly away without looking back. Harmony,
puzzled, glances down the alley at the car.

HARMONY
(to herself)
Nice car.

She hurries to catch up.

INT. HOTEL DONOHUE — ROOM NO. 1 — CONTINUOUS

A tiny second-floor office, nine by eleven feet. Dust in the slanting light. A rolltop desk, a coat rack, a single wooden chair, and a framed 1936 photograph of a young Black man in a straw boater standing in front of this same hotel on opening day: ALEXANDER DONOHUE, age 31.

Marc sits at the rolltop in his coat, with the brass key to Room No. 1 on the desk beside him. An old leather-bound ledger is open in front of him: DONOHUE HOTEL CO. — 1951-1953. Alexander's handwriting in faded brown ink.

He turns a page. He stops.

INSERT — THE LEDGER: The entries run from "Feb. 28, 1952" to "Mar. 3, 1952." And then the next page starts at "Mar. 19, 1952." Between them, a clean, straight edge where two pages have been cut out with a razor, flush to the binding.

Marc runs his thumb along the cut edge.

MARC
(quietly)

March 1952.

He looks up at the window, thinking.

Through the old wavy glass, down on the sidewalk, two women are walking away up Auburn Avenue. One in black. One in camel, with long dark hair, walking fast, not looking back.

Something about the one in camel. The way she moves.

Marc stands and goes to the window. He wipes a clear spot in the dust with his sleeve.

By the time he can see clearly, they've turned the corner.

He stands at the window a moment longer.

Then he goes back to the ledger and the razor-cut pages.

CUT TO:

6 INT. ATLANTA CITY HALL – COUNCIL CHAMBER – DAY

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 10:07 AM EST

A wood-paneled council chamber, half-full. Fifteen COUNCIL MEMBERS at a curved dais. A TV camera from the city channel. Reporters in the front row.

At the witness table, DEPUTY CHIEF WARREN HUGHES in full dress uniform, speaking into a microphone with total ease. Three other DEPUTY CHIEFS sit beside him, less comfortable.

In the second row of the gallery, in uniform, Elxa sits alone with a legal pad. She's writing nothing.

HUGHES

—and with respect, Madam President, Zone One is doing more with less than any zone in this city. My officers are working double shifts. I've got sergeants buying their own flashlight batteries at the Home Depot.

A murmur of sympathy from the dais.

COUNCIL PRESIDENT

Thank you, Deputy Chief.
Councilman Hardaway.

COUNCILMAN LEON HARDAWAY (43), smooth, in an expensive suit and a bow tie, leans into his microphone.

HARDAWAY

Deputy Chief Hughes. The new "Blackwater Task Force." Twelve detectives. A whole floor at City Hall East. Overtime, equipment, and now, I understand, a working relationship with the FBI.

(beat)

What is that costing the taxpayers of Atlanta, and where's the money coming from?

HUGHES

(beat, a small smile)

With respect, Councilman, you'd have to ask the Chief. I'm not in the loop on the Blackwater Task Force.

A ripple through the chamber. Heads turn toward the second row. Elxa doesn't move.

HARDAWAY

You're a deputy chief, and you're not in the loop?

HUGHES

(pleasantly)

The Chief keeps a small table, Councilman. She said so herself.

(beat)

I'm sure she has her reasons.

The reporters are writing. Hardaway looks past Hughes, at Elxa.

HARDAWAY

Chief Jackson. Would you like to answer that?

Elxa stands. Every camera in the room swings to her.

ELXA

(calm, clear)

The Blackwater Task Force costs one hundred and eighteen thousand dollars a month, Councilman. It comes out of the homicide overtime line, which I cut by the same amount on January third by

ending the overtime detail at the Governor's Mansion that nobody in this building has been able to justify since 1998.

(beat)

And Deputy Chief Hughes is very much in the loop. He'll be at my table tomorrow morning at nine, with everybody else.

A pause. A couple of council members suppress smiles.

HARDAWAY

(amused)

Thank you, Chief.

ELXA

(sitting)

Thank you, Councilman.

At the witness table, Hughes keeps his pleasant expression. Under the table, his hand closes into a fist.

FADE OUT.

ACT TWO

7 INT. BSI TOWER — 57TH FLOOR — "THE GHOST ROOM" — DAY
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 11:34 AM EST

Blue light and humming servers. Keisha in her chair with a Red Bull. Tobias at a side table with a stack of Chatham statements. Marc leans against the glass, still in his coat, with the Auburn Avenue dust on his sleeve.

KEISHA

Hong Kong's clear. The triad jewelry shop makes jade Buddhas for tourists in Macau and one very large order of onyx cufflinks for a Filipino senator.

(beat)

Israel called me back. A very nice rabbi's grandson. Closed Saturdays, answers email on Tuesdays. They haven't cut onyx since 1996. The father has emphysema from the dust.

(beat)

One left.

MARC

South Africa.

KEISHA

Kruger Precision Stoneworks. Johannesburg. Founded 1987. Specialty cutting, laser and waterjet. Monuments, corporate awards, gaming tokens for the casinos at Sun City.

(beat)

Gaming tokens, Marc. Round stone discs. Custom engraving. Exactly what our coins are.

MARC

And their website went down January fourth.

KEISHA

And their email server's in Pretoria, and it's behind a firewall a lot better than a monument shop needs.

(beat)

Somebody told them to go quiet.

MARC

How long?

KEISHA

Forty-eight hours. Maybe less. I need their order book, and it's not on anything connected to the internet. It's on an office computer somebody turns on at 8 AM Johannesburg time.

(beat)

That's one in the morning here. I'll be up anyway.

MARC

Friday.

KEISHA

Friday.

MARC

(to Tobias)

Chatham?

TOBIAS

The microfiche is in a basement in Savannah. The bank's records manager is a Baptist deaconess who loves lemon pound cake and has been at Chatham since Kennedy.

(beat)

Roman's cousin's wife sings in her choir. We'll have it by the end of the week. Gently.

MARC

(a small smile)

Gently.

He turns to go. At the door he stops.

MARC (CONT'D)

And tonight, after close. Dee's Kitchen. Ten-thirty.

KEISHA

(immediately)

Is that a meeting or a party?

MARC
It's her birthday.

TOBIAS
So both.

MARC
Saint's bringing the cake. Nobody
tells her.

KEISHA
(beat)
Marc. She's going to know.

MARC
She's always going to know. Show
up anyway.

He goes. Keisha and Tobias look at each other.

TOBIAS
What do you get the woman who has
everything?

KEISHA
(turning back to her
monitors)
A dishwasher that works. Hers
broke in November. She won't let
anybody fix it because she "likes
washing dishes."

TOBIAS
Nobody likes washing dishes.

KEISHA
Mama Dee likes being the person
who stays late.

CUT TO:

**8 INT. RAYBURN HOUSE OFFICE BUILDING — CONGRESSWOMAN
OLSON'S OFFICE — WASHINGTON, D.C. — DAY**
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 12:12 PM EST

A congressional office: flags, a big mahogany desk, framed
photos of Jasmine with Presidents Clinton and Carter, and
a signed photo of Barbara Jordan. Snow falls outside on
Independence Avenue.

CONGRESSWOMAN JASMINE DONOHUE OLSON (44), ten terms in,
sharp and polished in a red suit, sits behind the desk

with a phone to her ear. GORDON ELLIS (36), her chief of staff, lean and caffeinated, stands at the window with a folder.

JASMINE

(into phone)

I understand. No, I understand, Bill. I'm not asking you to show me anything. I'm asking whether I should get on a plane.

(listening, her face tightening)

Harbour Point.

(beat)

Spell it.

(listening, writing)

H-A-R-B-O-U-R. The British spelling.

(beat)

Thank you, Bill. I owe you a dinner. No. A good one.

She hangs up. She looks at what she wrote.

GORDON

Harbour Point?

JASMINE

A customs broker in Garden City, Georgia. A Donohue Shipping subsidiary. It's in the Deep Water file.

(beat)

The FBI thinks somebody's been moving cash through it.

GORDON

(carefully)

Moving cash for whom?

JASMINE

Bill wouldn't say. He said the word "Blackwater" and then he said "I didn't say that."

Gordon crosses to the desk.

GORDON

Congresswoman. With respect.
You're on Ways and Means. You're
up for ranking member on
Oversight in March. If your
family's name is attached to an
organized-crime investigation—

JASMINE

It's already attached, Gordon.
It's attached in three places. My
brother-in-law's law firm. My
nephew's company. And my father's
shipping line.

GORDON

(beat)

Then what do you want to do?

JASMINE

I want to go home.

(beat)

Book me on the Friday morning
Delta. And call Peter. Tell him
I'm coming home early.

GORDON

(writing)

He'll be thrilled.

JASMINE

(beat)

He'll be surprised. That's not
the same thing.

Gordon glances up at her. She doesn't elaborate.

JASMINE (CONT'D)

And Gordon. Don't tell my father
why.

GORDON

Why not?

JASMINE

(looking out at the
snow)

Because if my father doesn't
already know, he's going to be
embarrassed.

(beat)

And if he does already know, I
don't want to hear him lie to me.

CUT TO:

9 INT. SOUTH CITY KITCHEN — MIDTOWN — A CORNER TABLE — DAY*Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 12:48 PM EST*

A bright Southern restaurant on Crescent Avenue. White tablecloths, fried green tomatoes, and the lunch crowd.

Marc sits at a corner table, jacket off. Across from him, CELESTE VAUGHN (24), WBKG's weekend anchor, stunning in a camel turtleneck with her hair swept up. Her Coach bag sits on the chair beside her, zipped. A reporter's notebook peeks out of it.

CELESTE
You're distracted.

MARC
I'm looking at you.

CELESTE
You're looking at me the way you look at a spreadsheet. Where'd you go this morning? You've got dust on your coat.

MARC
(brushing his sleeve)
An old building.

CELESTE
Which old building?

MARC
Are you asking as my girlfriend or as Channel Eight?

CELESTE
(smiling)
Does it matter?

MARC
Everything matters with you.

She laughs. She reaches across and takes a fried green tomato off his plate.

CELESTE
So. Your goddaughter's mother is the most famous real-estate agent in Atlanta.

MARC

So I hear.

CELESTE

Esther Smilley's college
roommate.

MARC

(beat)

So I hear.

CELESTE

(watching him)

You've never met her. Esther
Smilley.

MARC

Never.

CELESTE

She came to your gate on your
birthday in a red Valentino and
turned around.

(beat)

I was there, remember? I saw her
face.

MARC

(lightly)

You were very gracious about it.

CELESTE

I was very gracious because it
was your birthday.

(beat)

It's not your birthday anymore,
Marc.

A beat. Marc sets down his fork.

MARC

What do you want to know?

CELESTE

Nothing. I want you to know I'm
not stupid.

MARC

I've never once thought you were
stupid.

CELESTE

(beat, softer)

Good.

Her cell phone buzzes in her bag. She glances at it without taking it out. The caller ID: M. OLSON. She silences it.

MARC

Work?

CELESTE

(zipping the bag)

Always.

She smiles at him, the camera smile. He smiles back.

MARC

Come to dinner Friday. Somewhere quiet.

CELESTE

Friday.

(beat)

Where?

MARC

Surprise.

CELESTE

(reaching for her
coffee)

I hate surprises. I'm a reporter.

MARC

That's why I'm doing it.

She laughs. Under the table, her hand rests on the zipped bag with the notebook in it.

INSERT – THE NOTEBOOK, glimpsed as she adjusts the bag: a page of her tight handwriting. "B&A – 3 of 7 Harlow. 11 of 19 gambling. 4 of 4 fire suits. -> 1 MORE NUMBER. Customs? Port of Savannah??"

She pushes it deeper into the bag.

CUT TO:

**10 INT. EMORY UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL – A PRIVATE
CONSULTATION SUITE – DAY**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 2:06 PM EST

A discreet, wood-paneled suite on a restricted floor: leather chairs, a desk, an exam table behind a screen. No name on the door.

DR. RAYMOND HARRINGTON (60s), white-haired, bow tie, a Chicago neurologist with a kind, blunt manner, sits across from Lucius and Vivienne. On the desk, a sheet of paper. On it, a spiral Lucius was asked to draw. The line wobbles like a seismograph.

Lucius's ebony walking stick leans against his chair.

HARRINGTON

Your right-hand tremor has progressed since October. Your handwriting has gotten smaller. Micrographia. And your gait's changed. You're shortening your stride on the right.

LUCIUS

I have a cane.

HARRINGTON

You have a cane you're using, Lucius. Two years ago it was an accessory.

A beat. Vivienne's hand finds her husband's.

VIVIENNE

How fast?

HARRINGTON

Faster than I told you it would be in 2003. Not as fast as it could be.

(beat)

I'm going to increase the carbidopa-levodopa. It'll help. For a while, it'll help a great deal. You'll have good days that'll make you think I was wrong.

(beat)

I wasn't.

LUCIUS

How long?

HARRINGTON

Until what?

LUCIUS

Until people can see it.

HARRINGTON

(carefully)

Some of them can see it now.

(beat)

Eighteen months before it's hard to hide in a boardroom. Maybe two years. Then you'll have to decide what you tell your company.

LUCIUS

(evenly)

Eighteen months.

VIVIENNE

Lucius.

LUCIUS

Eighteen months is long enough.

HARRINGTON

For what?

LUCIUS

(beat)

To finish something my father started.

Harrington looks at Vivienne. She looks back at him, calm, and says nothing at all.

HARRINGTON

(quietly)

Lucius. Stress makes it worse. I'm telling you this as your doctor and as a man who's known you since Hyde Park. Whatever you're finishing, it'll finish you faster.

LUCIUS

(standing, taking his cane)

Then I'll have to be efficient.

He walks to the door. His right foot drags, just slightly. He stops at the door, straightens his shoulders, and walks out like a king.

Harrington watches him go. Vivienne gathers her coat.

HARRINGTON

Vivienne. Does anyone else in the family know?

VIVIENNE

(beat)

His mother suspects. His brother is watching. His daughter looked away at the dinner table.

(beat)

And his son voted against his daughter yesterday morning without noticing a thing.

HARRINGTON

Which son?

VIVIENNE

(a thin, beautiful smile)

He only has the one, Raymond.

She goes.

Harrington sits alone with the wobbly spiral. He files it in a folder marked, in his own handwriting, "L. VIVIENNE – CONFIDENTIAL."

FADE OUT.

ACT THREE**11 INT. MERRIWEATHER & SONS FUNERAL HOME – SILAS'S OFFICE – DAY**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 3:02 PM EST

A hushed, old-money office above the West End chapel: oxblood leather, a rolltop desk, framed photos of Silas with three mayors and Muhammad Ali, and a window looking two blocks down the boulevard to the sign for DEE'S KITCHEN.

Silas sits behind the desk polishing his silver fork with a handkerchief. OTIS stands by the door.

TEDDY MERRIWEATHER (26), Silas's nephew, sharp-dressed in a camel overcoat he hasn't taken off, paces in front of the desk.

TEDDY

Flowers, Unc. You sent that woman flowers. In the HEARSE.

SILAS

(polishing)

It's her birthday.

TEDDY

Two of ours are in the ground, and you're sending birthday flowers to the woman who runs their kitchen.

SILAS

Lamar Whitlock wasn't "ours," Theodore. Lamar ran numbers for us on Tuesdays and ushered at Greater Cascade on Sundays. Earl Tuggle paid us once in 1985 and then paid them for three years.

(beat)

Neither one of them belonged to anybody but God and their wives.

TEDDY

Everybody on Campbellton Road thinks Blackwater did it.

SILAS
Everybody on Campbellton Road
thought the Braves would win the
Series in '91.

TEDDY
(stopping)
You're scared of them.

Otis shifts by the door. Silas stops polishing.

SILAS
(quietly)
Say that again.

TEDDY
(holding his ground,
barely)
I said you're scared of them. The
whole city knows they took half
the Southside from us last summer
and you let them.

Silas sets the fork down on the blotter, very precisely.

SILAS
Sit down, nephew.

Teddy hesitates. Then he sits.

SILAS (CONT'D)
In 1964, a man named Floyd
Harkness ran numbers from
Bankhead to the river. He was the
scariest man I ever met. He had
two brothers and a shotgun and a
police captain on his payroll.
(beat)
I was seventeen. I sat across a
table from Floyd Harkness at the
Royal Peacock and told him I'd be
taking Bankhead. Do you know what
I had?

TEDDY
(sullen)
A gun?

SILAS
A fork.
(beat)
And patience. And a friend who'd
broken two of my fingers for

being rude to her and then taught
me how to hold a fork properly so
it wouldn't show.

He holds up his crooked left hand.

SILAS (CONT'D)

Floyd Harkness is dead. I'm not.
That's the only scoreboard.

(beat)

Somebody made fake coins,
Theodore. Somebody paid a deacon
twenty thousand dollars in new
hundreds the day after the
Smilleys announced they were
coming to town. Somebody wants
you and me to go to war with the
people on the other side of the
boulevard.

(beat)

And the man who wants that is not
your friend.

TEDDY

(beat)

How do you know it's a man?

SILAS

Because a woman would've been
smarter.

Otis almost smiles. Teddy doesn't.

TEDDY

And what if you're wrong?

SILAS

Then I'll be wrong in my own
time. Not somebody else's.

(picking the fork back
up)

Go on. And Theodore.

Teddy stops at the door.

SILAS (CONT'D)

Who'd you eat lunch with Monday?

A flicker in Teddy's face. Just one.

TEDDY

Nobody.

SILAS
(polishing)
Nobody. At the Waffle House on
Cleveland Avenue. For an hour and
ten minutes.
(beat)
Nobody must be very good company.

Teddy stares at him. Then he goes. The door closes.

Silas holds the silver fork up to the light. He looks at
his reflection in it.

SILAS (CONT'D)
(to Otis, without
turning)
Find out who Nobody is.

OTIS
Yes, sir.

CUT TO:

**12 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S
OFFICE – DAY**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 3:44 PM EST

The door is locked. The blinds are closed.

On Elxa's desk, five manila folders in a row. Each one is
stamped CONFIDENTIAL – COMMAND STAFF – BLACKWATER TASK
FORCE – EYES ONLY, and each is labeled with a name:
TOLBERT. KEMP. WASHINGTON. ALBRIGHT. HUGHES.

Elxa and Jeremy stand on either side of the desk in
shirtsleeves, feeding pages into the folders like card
dealers. A small stack of typed briefings sits beside each
one.

ELXA
Nine pages. Identical. Except
page six.

JEREMY
(sliding a page into
TOLBERT)
Tolbert's page six: the shooter
used a second, prepaid cell
phone.

ELXA
(sliding a page into
KEMP)
Kemp: the lab lifted a partial
print off the park coin.

JEREMY
Washington: a witness saw a red
sedan on Tenth Street at 7:05.

ELXA
Albright: Lamar Whitlock's widow
hired a private investigator in
December.

She holds the last page six. She reads it once more.

INSERT — THE PAGE: "6. CHIEF'S ASSESSMENT (NOT FOR
DISTRIBUTION): The Chief believes the coin recovered at
Piedmont Park is a FAKE and that the killings are the work
of a third party posing as the Blackwater Syndicate."

ELXA (CONT'D)
And Hughes.

JEREMY
(quietly)
The only true one.

ELXA
(beat)
The only true one.

JEREMY
If he leaks it, the whole city
knows the coin's fake. The killer
knows we know.

ELXA
The killer already knows it's
fake, Jeremy. He had it cut.
(beat)
The only people who don't know
are the press and the FBI. And
the FBI knows now, because I gave
them the coins.
(beat)
If it gets out, the only thing we
lose is a secret that isn't one.
And we gain a deputy chief.

She slides the page into the HUGHES folder. She closes it.

JEREMY

(beat)

I went to see my dad yesterday.

ELXA

I know. You came home and did the dishes without being asked. You only do that when you've been to Cascade Heights.

JEREMY

He knows it's Hughes. I could see it on his face.

(beat)

He said, "Hurt men leak. They don't do it for money. They do it so somebody knows they still matter."

Elxa stops.

JEREMY (CONT'D)

And he said if it's Warren, don't humiliate him. Don't walk him out in front of cameras. Take his badge in a room with the door closed and let him keep his pension.

A long silence. Elxa looks at the HUGHES folder.

ELXA

(quietly)

He humiliated me in front of the city council this morning. On television.

JEREMY

I know.

ELXA

He told a room full of reporters I keep him out of the loop.

JEREMY

You do keep him out of the loop.

ELXA

Because he LEAKS.

JEREMY

(gently)

Elx.

She sits down on the edge of the desk. She rubs her eyes.

ELXA
Your father trained him.

JEREMY
Yeah.

ELXA
Your father made him.

JEREMY
Yeah.

ELXA
(beat)
And your father still won't tell
you who told him to close the
Harlow case.

JEREMY
(beat)
No.

Elxa looks at the five folders. Then at her husband.

ELXA
If it's Hughes, I'll do it in a
room with the door closed.
(beat)
For your father. Not for Warren.

JEREMY
(softly)
That's enough.

He kisses her forehead. She leans into it for exactly one second.

Then she stands, stacks the five folders, and locks them in her desk drawer.

ELXA
Nine o'clock.

JEREMY
Nine o'clock.

CUT TO:

13 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – DAY

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 4:17 PM EST

Arianna at her desk, reviewing an indictment with a red pen. Dee's photograph grins down from the corkboard.

Her desk phone rings. She picks up.

ARIANNA

Cummings.

CARLA (V.O.)

(filtered, warm)

Madam District Attorney. Carla Mims. You have a minute?

ARIANNA

(setting down the pen)

Of course.

INTERCUT WITH:

INT. A PARKED BUICK – NORTHSIDE DRIVE NW – CONTINUOUS

Carla sits in an old maroon Buick LeSabre parked on the shoulder of Northside Drive, her thermos on the dash and a clipboard on the steering wheel. Out her windshield: a grand brick Georgian house behind iron gates. 3244.

CARLA

The Hendersons' guest list came in this morning. Mrs. Henderson's social secretary has kept every party list since 1979 in a filing cabinet. God bless the social secretaries of Buckhead.

(beat)

Two hundred and eleven names.

ARIANNA

(evenly)

That's a lot of interviews.

CARLA

It's a lot of interviews. I'm going to start with the valets and the two off-duty officers, and then I'll work down the list.

(beat)

You're on it, Madam District Attorney. You and your parents.

A beat. Arianna's hand is flat on the desk.

ARIANNA

I told you I was at a party.

CARLA

You did. You were honest with me.

(beat)

And Bernadette Sinclair put your picture in the Sentinel that Thursday. In a silver gown. You told her you were the designated driver.

Arianna closes her eyes for a moment.

ARIANNA

(lightly)

Bernadette's never gotten a quote wrong in thirty years.

CARLA

(chuckling)

No, ma'am.

(beat)

I'll need twenty minutes of your time tomorrow. As a witness. I'm asking everybody on that list the same four questions, and I'd like to ask you first, so nobody can ever say the District Attorney got treated different.

ARIANNA

(beat)

That's the right way to do it.

CARLA

I thought you'd say so.

(beat)

Two o'clock? Your office?

ARIANNA

Two o'clock.

CARLA

Thank you, Madam District Attorney.

The line clicks off.

In the Buick, Carla sets the phone down on the seat. She looks up at the Hendersons' house through the windshield.

Then she turns her head and looks down Northside Drive toward the curve. She looks at it for a long time. She writes something on the clipboard.

In the DA's office, Arianna sets the phone down. She picks up her red pen. It's shaking. She puts it down again.

She looks up at Dee's photograph.

ARIANNA
(barely a whisper)
Four questions.

CUT TO:

14 INT. RAVENHURST – VIVIENNE'S DRESSING ROOM – DUSK
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 4:46 PM EST

A mirrored jewel box of a dressing room: walls of shoes, a triple vanity with hundreds of crystal perfume bottles, and at the center of them, on a silver tray, one heavy flacon with a gold stopper shaped like smiling lips.
SMILE.

Vivienne sits at the vanity in a robe, her face bare, removing her earrings. She looks tired. She has just come from Emory.

Delphine stands behind her in a leather pencil skirt, lounging against a wall of Manolos.

DELPHINE
The Olson Estate. The main line.
Three calls to Kumasi last week,
all from the same number.

VIVIENNE
(to the mirror)
Mallory Olson.

DELPHINE
And Grace Bullock. They've been
in the catering kitchen at the
Olson Estate every afternoon for
a week. One of the Olsons'
housekeepers has a sister who
does our laundry. They're cooking
something in a double boiler that
smells like roses.
(beat)
And they have a green book.

Vivienne's hands stop on her earring.

VIVIENNE
(very quietly)
A green book.

DELPHINE
Green leather. Old. The
housekeeper says Mallory carries
it around like a Bible, and last
night she locked it in a wall
safe behind a painting.

Vivienne sets the earring down on the tray very gently.

VIVIENNE
Simone gave it to them.

DELPHINE
Gave what?

VIVIENNE
(beat)
The Toussaint Formulary. Simone
Toussaint's recipes. The rose
balm, the hair pomade, the shea
cream that half of Black
America's grandmothers used in
the 1940s.
(beat)
In 1976 I offered her two million
dollars for that book. I was
twenty-one. I had just become the
first Black woman to front a
French perfume campaign. I
thought I was the most beautiful
woman in the world and that
everyone had a price.

DELPHINE
And?

VIVIENNE
She sent me a jar of rose balm
and a note that said, "No, thank
you. But you may keep the jar."

Vivienne reaches to the back of the vanity. Among the
crystal, there's a small, old-fashioned amber glass jar
with a faded paper label: ROSE BALM NO. 7 – S.T. She's
kept it for twenty-nine years.

She doesn't open it. She never has.

DELPHINE
(watching her)
Mother. What do you want me to do?

VIVIENNE
(beat)
Nothing. Yet.
(beat)
Two girls in a kitchen with a seventy-year-old recipe book are not a business. They're a hobby.
(beat)
But the day they launch, Delphine, I want to already own their shea supplier, their beeswax supplier, their jar manufacturer, and the shelf at Saks they think is theirs.

DELPHINE
(smiling slowly)
Yes, Mother.

VIVIENNE
And Delphine.

DELPHINE
Yes?

VIVIENNE
(turning from the mirror to look at her daughter)
Not a word to your sister.

DELPHINE
(delighted)
Mother. I haven't told Esther anything since 1987.

She goes. Vivienne turns back to the mirror. She looks at the old amber jar in her reflection.

She picks it up. She turns it in her fingers.

VIVIENNE
(to the jar, softly)
Twenty-nine years, Simone.

She puts it back. Unopened.

CUT TO:

15 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE FAMILY DINING ROOM – NIGHT

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 6:33 PM EST

A long, formal dining room on West Paces Ferry: Georgian silver, a Venetian chandelier, portraits of Olsons and Donohues. Only one end of the table is set.

DR. PETER OLSON (45), plastic surgeon to Atlanta's rich and famous, silver at the temples, handsome and careful, in a cashmere sweater, sits at the head. Mallory sits at his right, already dressed to go out in a black jumpsuit, her hair blown out. Martin sits at his left in his waistcoat, cutting lamb.

A speakerphone sits in the middle of the table beside the salt cellar.

JASMINE (V.O.)
(through speaker)
—I'm on the Friday morning Delta.
I land at 10:40.

PETER
(surprised)
Friday? I thought you had the
Oversight retreat through Sunday.

JASMINE (V.O.)
I canceled it.

PETER
(beat)
Is everything all right?

JASMINE (V.O.)
Everything's fine, Peter. I miss
my family. Is that allowed?

MARTIN
(smoothly)
It's more than allowed, Mother.
It's overdue.

JASMINE (V.O.)
Martin. Are you eating?

MARTIN
Lamb.

JASMINE (V.O.)
Good. Mallory?

MALLORY
I'm going out.

JASMINE (V.O.)
On a Wednesday?

MALLORY
Grace is showing me a club. For
Grace and Glory research. Market
research.

JASMINE (V.O.)
(dry)
Of course it is.
(beat)
Peter. Midnight.

PETER
(to Mallory)
Midnight.

MALLORY
(rolling her eyes)
I'm nineteen.

PETER AND JASMINE (V.O.)
(together)
Midnight.

Mallory groans. Martin smiles into his wine.

JASMINE (V.O.)
I have a vote. I love you all.
Peter, call me later.

The line clicks off. Peter presses the button to end the
call.

PETER
(to Mallory, gentler)
Where's the club?

MALLORY
Buckhead. Velvet.

PETER
(beat)
Your uncle Alvin's club.

MALLORY
Unofficially. Why does everybody
keep saying that like it's a
crime scene?

PETER

Because your uncle Alvin's
friends are the kind of people I
see in the emergency room at
three in the morning.

(beat)

And the kind of people I—

He stops.

MALLORY

The kind of people you what?

PETER

(beat)

The kind of people I'd rather you
didn't meet.

His cell phone buzzes on the table beside his plate. He
glances at it.

INSERT — THE PHONE'S DISPLAY: "+52 998 ..." A long foreign
number. Mexico.

Peter's face changes. It's small, a tightening around the
eyes. He turns the phone face down.

MARTIN

(watching him)

Aren't you going to get that?

PETER

(too quickly)

A patient. Somebody who wants a
consultation. It can wait.

MARTIN

From Mexico?

PETER

(beat)

People come from all over,
Martin.

The phone buzzes again under his hand, face down. He
doesn't pick it up. He cuts his lamb.

Mallory's watching her father. She's never seen him not
pick up a phone.

A car horn honks outside. Twice. Then a third time,
longer.

MALLORY
(jumping up)
That's Grace.

She kisses her father's cheek.

MALLORY (CONT'D)
Midnight. I promise.

PETER
(squeezing her hand)
Be careful, sweetheart.

She hurries out. Martin sips his wine and looks at his father.

MARTIN
Mexico.

PETER
(evenly)
Eat your dinner, Martin.

Martin eats his dinner. His eyes don't leave his father's face-down phone.

CUT TO:

16 INT. BELLE RIVE — GRACE'S BEDROOM — NIGHT
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 7:44 PM EST

A pop star's childhood bedroom: platinum records on the wall, a Sweet Tea cast photo, a Tiffany lamp, and a mountain of clothes on the bed. Grace, in a slip, holds up two dresses in front of a floor-length mirror.

Natasha sits on the window seat in her robe with a cup of tea, watching her.

GRACE
Gold or black?

NATASHA
Black.

GRACE
Gold.

NATASHA
Then why did you ask?

GRACE

To make sure.

(beat)

Mal's going to wear black. We
can't both wear black. We'll look
like a funeral.

NATASHA

You'll look like two girls who
have a curfew.

GRACE

Mal has a curfew. I'm twenty.

NATASHA

You live in my house.

GRACE

(grinning)

Then I'm twenty in your house.

She shimmies into the gold. She turns to the mirror. She
looks incredible. Natasha smiles despite herself.

NATASHA

Lo's going to be there?

GRACE

Lo's doing the walk-through with
Uncle Alvin's manager. For the
showcase. March.

NATASHA

(beat)

Is your uncle going to be there?

GRACE

Uncle Alvin's in Miami. He's
always in Miami.

(beat)

He sent me a text Tuesday. "proud
of u gracie. velvet is urs
anytime." He can't spell, but
he's sweet.

Natasha looks into her tea. Grace catches her mother's
face in the mirror.

GRACE (CONT'D)

Mama.

NATASHA

Hmm?

GRACE
(turning around)
Are you and Daddy okay?

A beat. Natasha sets the cup down on the window seat.

NATASHA
Why do you ask?

GRACE
Because at dinner Monday, Daddy
laughed at something that wasn't
funny. And Nana Ruby told him
he'd need more gravy. And Nana
Ruby only says things like that
when somebody's in trouble.
(beat)
And you've been wearing your
Donohue face all week.

NATASHA
(beat)
My what?

GRACE
Your Donohue face. The one you
wear on CNBC. Where you smile
with your mouth and not with
anything else.

Natasha looks at her daughter for a long moment. Twenty, a
pop star, not stupid.

NATASHA
(gently)
Come here.

Grace crosses to the window seat. Natasha stands and zips
the back of the gold dress the last inch.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
Your father and I have been
married twenty-three years.

GRACE
I know.

NATASHA
When you've been married
twenty-three years, baby, there
are weeks when you're okay and
weeks when you're working on it.
(beat)

This is a working-on-it week.

GRACE
(searching her face)
Is it bad?

NATASHA
(smoothing her
daughter's hair,
smiling now with
everything)
It's handled.

Grace studies her. Then she hugs her mother, hard.

GRACE
(into her shoulder)
You'd tell me.

NATASHA
(holding her)
I'd tell you when there's
something to tell.

Outside, Grace's car horn: her driver in the motor court.
Grace pulls back, grabs a clutch and a coat, and runs for
the door.

GRACE
Mal's in the car! Love you!

NATASHA
Midnight!

GRACE
(gone)
I'M TWENTY!

The door slams. Natasha stands alone in her daughter's
room among the platinum records and the tossed dresses.

Nana Ruby appears in the doorway with a stack of folded
towels.

RUBY
(quietly)
"It's handled."

NATASHA
(not turning)
Don't, Ruby.

RUBY
I didn't say a word.
(beat, going)
I just repeated one.

FADE OUT.

ACT FOUR**17 INT. RAVENHURST – THE LIBRARY – NIGHT**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 8:39 PM EST

The two-story French library. Fire in the hearth. Esther, in a black sweater, sits curled in a leather chair with a stack of Auburn Avenue plat maps, a highlighter, and a glass of red wine.

Crowe stands in front of the fire.

CROWE

Your uncle left the tower at eight-fifteen. His driver's taking the long way to the Ritz-Carlton Buckhead. Down Peachtree, around Lenox. Twice.

ESTHER

(not looking up)
He's being careful.

CROWE

He's always careful. Tonight he's being theatrical.

(beat)

I have a man in the bar. He's been there since seven, drinking club soda and reading the Journal-Constitution very slowly.

ESTHER

Camera?

CROWE

A disposable in his coat pocket. He's a retired Chicago cop. He's photographed worse people in worse bars.

Esther caps the highlighter.

ESTHER

Thaddeus. If it's who I think it is—

CROWE

Who do you think it is?

ESTHER

(beat)

Someone from across the street.

CROWE

The Donohues don't meet Smilleys
in bars, ma'am.

ESTHER

(looking into the fire)

Not the Donohues. Someone who
wants to be one.

Crowe studies her.

CROWE

You'll have the pictures by
breakfast.

ESTHER

Thank you.

(beat)

And Thaddeus. Harmony Divine's
daughter was here yesterday. With
the twins. Somebody took a
photograph through the
morning-room window with a long
lens and put it on the internet.

(beat)

I want every window on the south
lawn tinted by Friday. And I want
to know the name of every
photographer who's been on
Ravenhurst Lane since New Year's.

CROWE

(beat)

It'll be Vince Marette.

ESTHER

Then I want to know what Vince
Marette wants.

CROWE

Vince Marette wants the first
photograph of your daughters'
father.

Esther goes absolutely still. Crowe says it evenly, a
fact, like reading a weather report.

ESTHER

(very quietly)

The donor's anonymous.

CROWE

Yes, ma'am. That's what makes the photograph valuable.

A long beat. The fire pops.

ESTHER

Tint the windows.

CROWE

Yes, ma'am.

He goes. Esther sits alone. She picks up her wine. She doesn't drink it.

She looks at the fire.

CUT TO:

18 INT. THE RITZ-CARLTON BUCKHEAD – THE LOBBY LOUNGE BAR – NIGHT

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 9:02 PM EST

Old-world Buckhead: dark paneling, oil paintings of horses, a crackling fireplace, and a pianist playing Gershwin to nobody. Leather club chairs in quiet clusters. A corner table set apart by a potted palm.

At the bar, a heavysset white man in his sixties, CROWE'S MAN, reads the Journal-Constitution very slowly and nurses a club soda.

At the corner table, Desmond Smilley sits alone with a cognac, one leg crossed over the other. A RITZ-CARLTON BARTENDER sets down a second glass: sparkling water, lime, no ice.

Martin Olson walks in from the lobby in a charcoal overcoat, which he hands to the hostess without looking at her. He crosses the room and sits across from Desmond, unhurried.

MARTIN

Mr. Smilley.

DESMOND

Mr. Olson.

(nodding at the
sparkling water)

I was told you don't drink.

MARTIN

You were told correctly.

DESMOND

Your grandfather drinks. Your great-grandfather drank. I understand your uncle Alvin drinks enough for the whole family.

MARTIN

(picking up the water)
Someone has to be sober at the end of the evening, Mr. Smilley. Otherwise, who remembers what was said?

Desmond smiles. He likes that.

DESMOND

You asked for this meeting.

MARTIN

I did.

DESMOND

You're twenty-three years old. You're a senior vice president at a company your grandfather built and your aunt runs. You're the eldest grandchild, and you've been passed over for a younger cousin.

(beat)
Why would I have a drink with you?

MARTIN

(pleasantly)
Because you came.

A beat. Desmond concedes the point with a tilt of his glass.

MARTIN (CONT'D)

It seems we have the same problem.

DESMOND

Do we.

MARTIN

Your brother named his youngest child heir to one of the largest companies in the world. On her twenty-first birthday. At a gala. Over his eldest son. Over you.

(beat)

My great-grandfather's codicil names my cousin heir apparent to Donohue Global Holdings. Vice Chair-designate on his twenty-fifth birthday. Over my mother. Over me.

(sipping)

Two twenty-three-year-olds, Mr. Smilley. Two birthday parties. Two families that decided the future belongs to whoever smiles best in photographs.

DESMOND

(beat)

Esther's twenty-two.

MARTIN

She'll be twenty-three in September. I'm rounding up.

Desmond swirls his cognac.

DESMOND

And what do you imagine we do about our problem? Two gentlemen in a hotel bar.

MARTIN

Nothing. Tonight.

(beat)

Tonight, I give you something. For free.

DESMOND

Nothing's free.

MARTIN

This is. That's how you'll know I'm serious.

Martin sets his glass down. He speaks quietly, conversationally, as if discussing the weather.

MARTIN (CONT'D)

At eleven-oh-four this morning, a United flight from Chicago O'Hare landed at Hartsfield. In first class, seat 2A, was Dr. Raymond Harrington of Northwestern Memorial Hospital.

(beat)

Dr. Harrington spent four hours in a private suite on a restricted floor at Emory University Hospital, under the name "L. Vivienne." Then he flew home on the six o'clock.

Desmond's glass stops halfway to his mouth.

MARTIN (CONT'D)

Dr. Harrington is one of the three leading movement-disorder specialists in the United States.

(beat)

I don't know what he told your brother. But I know what he treats.

A long silence. The pianist moves into "Someone to Watch Over Me."

DESMOND

(very quietly)

How do you know that?

MARTIN

The same way you know which floor of Donohue Tower my office is on. I pay attention.

(beat)

Your brother voted left-handed yesterday, Mr. Smilley. I'd have thought you of all people would have noticed.

DESMOND

(setting the glass down)

I noticed.

MARTIN

Then you know the clock's running. Your brother doesn't have forever to make sure your niece is in the chair.

(beat)
And neither do you.

Desmond studies the young man across the table. He's been in boardrooms for thirty years. He knows exactly what he's looking at.

DESMOND
And what do you want for this...
gift?

MARTIN
Nothing. That's the point of a
gift.
(beat)
Someone very wise once told me:
never make a man an ally. Make
him a creditor. Allies leave.

DESMOND
(slowly)
And you'd like me to owe you.

MARTIN
I'd like you to remember this
conversation the next time you
have something I need.

DESMOND
(beat)
And what might you need?

MARTIN
(standing, buttoning
his jacket)
I'll know when you tell me.

He doesn't leave. He stands there a moment, looking down at Desmond.

MARTIN (CONT'D)
I'll be in the bar until
midnight, Mr. Smilley. The
piano's good. If you think of
anything you'd like to say to
someone who can keep a secret,
I'll be at the other end of the
room.

He walks away to a club chair by the fire at the far end of the lounge. He sits down with his sparkling water and opens a book.

At the bar, Crowe's man turns a page of the Journal-Constitution. Under the newspaper, a disposable camera. CLICK.

Desmond sits alone at the corner table. He looks down at his cognac.

He doesn't leave either.

CUT TO:

19 INT. VELVET NIGHTCLUB – BUCKHEAD – NIGHT

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 10:14 PM EST

A converted Buckhead warehouse: black lacquer, red velvet banquettes, a thirty-foot bar backlit in amber, and a sunken dance floor under a chandelier made of shattered mirrors. It's Wednesday, and it's packed. Beautiful people, a haze of fog, and a bass line you can feel in your teeth.

Above the dance floor, in a glass DJ booth: a silhouette in headphones, one hand raised.

A VELVET BOUNCER (30s, enormous) unhooks the velvet rope for Grace in the gold dress and Mallory in the black jumpsuit. The crowd along the line recognizes Grace and SCREAMS.

GRACE

(waving, blowing
kisses, to Mallory
through her smile)

Keep walking. Don't stop. If you
stop, they'll want pictures.

MALLORY

(overwhelmed)

Is it always like this?

GRACE

Only when I'm here.

LIONEL "LO" PIERCE (39), Grace's manager, in a leather blazer and too much cologne, waves them through a side corridor, beaming.

LO

My girl! My GIRL! Platinum in six
weeks and she still comes out on
a Wednesday!

(to Mallory)

And the cousin! The brains! Lo
Pierce. Pleasure.

MALLORY
(shaking his hand)
Mallory.

LO
(to Grace)
Alvin's manager's upstairs. Ten
minutes, baby. Walk the room,
talk about the stage, look
pretty, go home.

GRACE
(to Mallory)
Ten minutes. Get a drink. A
NON-alcoholic drink, you have a
curfew.

MALLORY
I'm NINETEEN.

GRACE
(already going)
That's what I said!

Grace and Lo vanish up a staircase. Mallory stands alone
at the edge of the dance floor, a little lost in the fog.

The music shifts.

Out of a hard house beat, clean as church bells, the
opening of Minnie Riperton's "Lovin' You." The crowd
groans, laughs, then screams as the DJ drops the bass
under it, and the chorus flips into Kanye West's "Through
the Wire."

The whole room loses its mind.

Mallory laughs out loud in spite of herself. She looks up
at the glass booth.

The DJ's looking down at her.

QUENTIN SMILLEY (21), though nobody here calls him that.
Velvet blazer over a white T-shirt, headphones around his
neck, a gold chain, a grin that knows exactly how good
that transition was. He tips two fingers off his brow at
her.

Mallory, caught looking, looks away.

Then she looks back. He's still looking.

At the bar, she orders a club soda with lime. When the bartender sets it down, there's a napkin under it. Written in Sharpie:

INSERT – THE NAPKIN: "you laughed at the minnie. that makes you the only person in here with taste. break in 20. don't leave. – Q"

Mallory looks up at the booth. He's back at the decks, head down, working.

She folds the napkin and tucks it into her clutch.

FADE OUT.

ACT FIVE

20 INT. DEE'S KITCHEN — WEST END — AFTER CLOSING — NIGHT
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 10:41 PM EST

The restaurant after hours. Chairs up on half the tables. The neon sign in the window says CLOSED. The yellow roses and the white lilies sit side by side on the counter.

Mama Dee, apron still on, sweeps the floor behind the counter. The gospel radio plays low.

The bell over the front door JINGLES.

MAMA DEE
(not looking up)
We're closed. Go home.

MARC (O.S.)
We know.

She looks up.

Marc stands in the doorway in a black sweater, holding a pink bakery box. Behind him, crowding in out of the cold: Amond, Tobias, Keisha, Roman, and Saint, who holds a three-tier coconut cake with fifty-four candles, already lit, dripping wax.

SAINT
(singing, badly)
Happy birthday to youuuu—

ALL
(joining, terribly)
—happy birthday to youuuu—

Mama Dee puts her hands on her hips. Her eyes are already wet.

MAMA DEE
You are all going to get me
arrested.

ALL
—happy BIRTHDAY, dear MAMA DEEEE—

ROMAN
(solo, a surprisingly
beautiful baritone)
Happy birthday... to you.

Silence. Everybody turns and stares at Roman.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
(shrugging)
Church choir. Fayetteville.
Eleven years.

KEISHA
(stunned)
I've known you four years.

ROMAN
You never asked.

Mama Dee laughs. She blows out the candles, all fifty-four of them, in three breaths. Everybody cheers.

LATER.

The chairs are down. They're crowded into one big red booth and two pulled-up tables, eating coconut cake off paper plates with plastic forks. Mama Dee sits in the middle like a queen.

Tobias slides her an envelope.

TOBIAS
From all of us.

She opens it. A receipt. A commercial dishwasher, Hobart, installation paid, delivery tomorrow at 7 AM.

MAMA DEE
(outraged)
I LIKE washing dishes!

KEISHA
You like staying late. Now you
can stay late and sit down.

MAMA DEE
(glaring at her, then
softening)
Hobart.

KEISHA
The good one.

Marc slides the pink bakery box across the table.

MARC
And this is from me. It's not a
cake.

She opens it. Inside, in tissue, a small silver frame. A black-and-white photograph, beautifully restored: a young couple on the steps of a church in 1970. A young man in a narrow suit, laughing. A girl of nineteen in a white dress with a short veil, laughing harder.

Mama Dee stops breathing.

MAMA DEE
(barely)
Where did you get this?

MARC
Ghost found it. The Atlanta Daily World wedding announcements, June 1970. Their archive was water damaged. She had it restored in Chicago.

KEISHA
(quietly)
It took three months.

Mama Dee holds the frame in both hands. She touches the young man's face through the glass.

MAMA DEE
(whispering)
I didn't have one. Not one picture. The house fire in '74 took all of them.
(beat)
I was starting to forget what he looked like when he laughed.

Nobody says anything. Saint puts his hand on her shoulder. She puts her hand over his.

MAMA DEE (CONT'D)
(finally, gruff, wiping her eyes)
Y'all are going to make me ruin my face.

AMOND
Your face is fine, Mama.

MAMA DEE
My face is fifty-four, baby.

She sets the frame upright on the table, facing her. She clears her throat. The room shifts. The party's over. The Table is in session, even at a diner booth.

MAMA DEE (CONT'D)

Now. Somebody tell me something I
need to know before I cry again.

MARC

Ghost.

KEISHA

One shop left. Kruger Precision
Stoneworks. Johannesburg. They
make gaming tokens for casinos.
Their website went dark the day
after Lamar. I'll be in their
order book by Friday.

SAINT

And I've got something.

(beat)

Teddy Merriweather ate lunch
Monday at the Waffle House on
Cleveland Avenue. An hour and ten
minutes. With a white man.

(beat)

Tall. Thirties. Short hair. Moved
like a soldier. My man sat two
booths over. He said the dude had
an accent, "like Australian, but
not."

Roman sets down his fork.

ROMAN

(quietly)

The van driver at Tenth and
Piedmont. "Moves like a soldier."

SAINT

Same description.

The booth goes very still.

MARC

(low)

So he's talking to Teddy.

AMOND

He's recruiting Teddy.

MAMA DEE

(sharply)

Silas knows.

Everybody looks at her.

MAMA DEE (CONT'D)

Silas knows his nephew's been eating with somebody. Otis told Tanisha at the counter this afternoon. Silas asked the boy straight out who he ate lunch with, and the boy said "nobody."
(beat)
Silas said, "Nobody must be very good company."

A beat. Marc almost smiles.

MARC

Mama Dee. Call Silas tomorrow. Tell him we're looking for the same Nobody. Tell him when we find him, it's like we promised at the funeral. We share.

MAMA DEE

(beat)
He'll want more than a promise.

MARC

(beat)
Then tell him Friday.

MAMA DEE

You said Friday last week.

MARC

I know.
(beat)
This Friday, I'll have a name.

Mama Dee holds his eyes. Then she nods.

MARC (CONT'D)

Roman. The Waffle House. Cleveland Avenue. They've got a camera over the register. Every Waffle House does.

ROMAN

(already standing)
Tonight.

MAMA DEE

(grabbing his sleeve)
Sit down and finish your cake, Roman Gaines. It's my birthday. The Waffle House is open all

night. That's the whole point of
a Waffle House.

Roman sits back down. He finishes his cake. Everybody
laughs.

Marc leans back in the booth. He watches them: his family,
the one he built.

MARC
(to Mama Dee, quietly,
under the chatter)
My grandfather says to tell you
the crust is better than it was
in 1994.

Mama Dee snorts.

MAMA DEE
You tell Victor Donohue I
remember when he used to tip in
quarters.
(beat)
And you tell him I said happy
seventh night.

MARC
(beat)
How do you know about the seventh
night?

MAMA DEE
(serenely, eating cake)
Baby. Everybody knows about the
seventh night.

CUT TO:

21 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE LIBRARY — NIGHT
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 — 10:58 PM EST

Night seven. The fire is high tonight. The quilt and
pillow are folded on the Chesterfield for the last time.

Victor sits in his armchair in his pajamas and robe. On
his knee, the courier log, turned to October. Beside him,
a note from Suttles on Donohue Shipping stationery, faxed
from Garden City at 6 PM.

Joan comes in with the tray. Two cups. She sets it down
and sits across from him without being asked.

JOAN

Last night.

VICTOR

Last night.

JOAN

Your mother is having a small celebration at breakfast tomorrow. She ordered a cake.

VICTOR

(dry)

Of course she did.

Joan pours. She hands him his cup. She notices the fax.

JOAN

Garden City?

VICTOR

(beat)

Wendell found Pettaway's boxes. There are three designation letters on file for the Harbour Point account. Two are from 1998 and 2001, signed by Pettaway himself. Routine.

(beat)

The third is dated October 15, 2004. "Office of the Chairman." My stamp. No signature. It authorizes "the bearer."

JOAN

The day after the courier.

VICTOR

The day after "M." signed for the Harbour Point file on my floor.

A long silence. The fire crackles.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Joan. Who in this family starts with M?

JOAN

(slowly)

Marc. Martin. Mallory.

(beat)

And me, if you count "Mother," which the grandchildren do when

they want something.

VICTOR
Mallory runs Peter's office and
doesn't know what a customs
broker is.

JOAN
(beat)
Victor.

VICTOR
Martin works on eighty-six. He's
on eighty-eight twice a week.
(beat)
And Marc asked me about Harbour
Point on Monday night. In this
room. Before I'd said the name
out loud to anyone in my life.

Joan sets down her cup.

JOAN
(very quietly)
Victor. Marc brought you cobbler.

VICTOR
He brought me cobbler. And a
question.
(beat)
And when I asked him why, he
wouldn't tell me.

JOAN
You told him you'd decided not to
ask.

VICTOR
(beat)
I did.

JOAN
Then don't start asking now in
the wrong direction.

VICTOR
Which direction is the right one,
Judge?

Joan looks at the fire.

JOAN

Every direction, Victor. That's the right one. Every direction, in the same order, with the same questions, and no favorites.

(beat)

You taught Natasha that. You taught me that, in 1966, when Theodore wanted the Chairman's seat and you had to prove you didn't just want it more.

Victor looks at his wife. A long beat.

VICTOR

(quietly)

I love that boy more than anything on this earth.

JOAN

I know.

VICTOR

If it's him—

JOAN

It isn't.

VICTOR

You don't know that.

JOAN

(beat)

No. I don't.

(beat)

But I know which of our grandchildren didn't cry at his christening.

Victor stares at her.

VICTOR

(beat)

Mother said that to you.

JOAN

Your mother says a great many things to me. Most of them I pretend not to hear.

She stands. She picks up both cups. At the door, she stops.

JOAN (CONT'D)

Tomorrow night you sleep in your
own bed. Seven nights. It's a new
record.

(beat)

Don't try for eight.

She goes. Victor sits alone by the fire with the courier
log and the fax.

He picks up a pen. On the back of the fax, in his strong,
square hand, he writes three names in a column:

INSERT — THE FAX: "MARC. MARTIN. MALLORY."

He looks at them. He draws a line through MALLORY.

His pen hovers over the other two.

He doesn't cross either one out.

FADE OUT.

ACT SIX

22 INT. VELVET NIGHTCLUB – THE ROOFTOP TERRACE – NIGHT
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 11:31 PM EST

A small rooftop terrace behind the DJ booth: string lights, two heat lamps, a couple of weathered couches, and a view of the Buckhead skyline glowing in the cold. The bass throbs through the floor.

Mallory sits on one end of a couch in a borrowed Velvet staff hoodie over her jumpsuit, a club soda in her hands. Q sits on the other end with a bottle of water, headphones around his neck, his breath fogging.

They've been talking for twenty minutes. It shows.

MALLORY

—and then my father says,
"Mallory, you can't bill Aetna
for a nose job twice just because
the first one was on a Tuesday."
And I said, "Daddy, I didn't.
Tammy did." And he fired Tammy.
On Christmas Eve.

Q

(laughing)

Your dad fired somebody on
Christmas Eve?

MALLORY

I fired her. He just signed it.
He can't fire anybody. He cries.

Q

(delighted)

You're ruthless.

MALLORY

I'm efficient.

Q

That's what ruthless people say.

She laughs. He laughs. It's easy.

MALLORY

Okay. Your turn. Where are you
from?

Q
(beat)
Chicago.

MALLORY
What part?

Q
The part with the lake.

MALLORY
(dry)
That's all of it.

Q
(grinning)
Then you know exactly where I'm
from.

MALLORY
What's your name?

Q
Q.

MALLORY
Q what?

Q
Just Q.

MALLORY
Nobody's name is just Q.

Q
Mine is. Tonight.
(beat)
You don't want my last name. My
last name comes with a family,
and my family comes with
opinions. Q comes with a good set
and a bottle of water.

MALLORY
(beat)
My last name comes with a family
too.

Q
(beat)
I know.
(off her look)

You came in with Grace Bullock.
You're the cousin. Everybody in
this club knows who the cousin
is.

(beat)
I just don't care.

She looks at him. He looks back. No grin now. Just a young
man on a cold roof who means it.

MALLORY
(quietly)
Why not?

Q
Because you laughed at the Minnie
Riperton. Three hundred people in
there were waiting for Kanye. You
were the only one who heard the
song underneath.

(beat)
That's not a last name. That's a
person.

Her cell phone buzzes in her clutch. She pulls it out. A
text from GRACE.

INSERT — THE TEXT: "its 1145. car is out front. curfew
cinderella"

Mallory looks at the text. She looks at Q.

Q (CONT'D)
(gently)
You've got to go.

MALLORY
(beat)
I've got a curfew.

Q
Then go. I'll be here next
Wednesday.

She looks at the phone for a long moment. Then she types,
with her thumb:

INSERT — HER TEXT: "go without me. i'll get a cab. cover
for me."

She hits send. She puts the phone face down on the couch.

Q raises his eyebrows.

MALLORY
(defiantly)
I'm nineteen.

Q
(slow smile)
I know.

MALLORY
Tell me about Chicago. The part
with the lake.

He leans back against the couch arm. Behind him, the
Buckhead towers glitter. The bass throbs through the roof.

Q
Okay. But you have to promise not
to fall asleep. It's a long lake.

MALLORY
(pulling the hoodie
tighter, settling in)
I promise.

CUT TO:

23 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE FRONT FOYER – NIGHT
Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 11:44 PM EST

The grand foyer: a double staircase, a black-and-white
marble floor, and a tall grandfather clock ticking toward
midnight. Only a single lamp is lit on the hall table.

Peter sits on the bottom step of the staircase in his
cashmere sweater, his phone in his hand. Waiting.

He looks at the clock. Eleven forty-four.

He looks at his phone. One new voicemail. From +52 998.

He presses play. He holds it to his ear.

VOICEMAIL (V.O.)
(a man, soft Mexican
accent, filtered)
Doctor Olson. It's Esteban Ruiz,
from Clínica Esperanza, in
Cancún. I'm sorry to call so
late.
(beat)
Someone came to the clinic this
week. A man. He asked about our

records from 2001. About the
American doctor who used our
operating room in the summer.
About one patient in particular.

(beat)

I told him we had a fire in 2002,
and there are no records. But I
thought you should know.

(beat)

Please call me.

The message ends.

Peter sits very still. His thumb hovers over the phone.

He presses DELETE.

He looks up at the grandfather clock. Eleven forty-six. He
puts his face in his hands.

On the landing above, in the dark, Martin stands in his
shirtsleeves with a glass of sparkling water, looking down
at his father.

Peter doesn't know he's there.

Martin watches a moment longer. Then he turns and goes
silently back up the stairs.

CUT TO:

**24 INT. THE RITZ-CARLTON BUCKHEAD – THE LOBBY LOUNGE BAR
– LATER**

Wednesday, January 12, 2005 – 11:52 PM EST

The lounge is nearly empty now. The pianist is packing up.
The fire has burned low. Crowe's man at the bar is gone.

Martin sits in the club chair by the fire at the far end
of the room, reading his book. He turns a page.

Footsteps across the carpet. Desmond Smilley stands in
front of him with a fresh cognac in his hand.

Martin looks up. He closes the book over one finger.

MARTIN

Mr. Smilley.

Desmond sits down in the chair across from him, without
asking.

DESMOND

(quietly)

My niece has had a secret since
Chicago.

Martin says nothing. He waits.

DESMOND (CONT'D)

The twins were born May 10, 2002.
She told the family it was IVF.
An anonymous donor. A clinic in
Zurich.

(beat)

There is no clinic in Zurich that
did an IVF transfer for an Esther
Smilley in 2001. I checked. In
2003. Every one of them.

MARTIN

(evenly)

Babies still happen the
old-fashioned way, Mr. Smilley.

DESMOND

They do.

(beat)

Nine months back from May 10th is
the first week of September 2001.

(beat)

And my niece, who has never in
her life gone anywhere she wasn't
photographed, has no pictures
from the first week of September
2001. None. Not in our archives.
Not in a single magazine.

Martin sets his book on the side table.

DESMOND (CONT'D)

And since we moved to this city,
she's driven to one gate twice in
one week, and turned around both
times.

(beat)

Your family's gate.

The fire crackles. Martin is very still.

MARTIN

(slowly)

And the night she turned around
in a red Valentino, a friend of
mine in the gatehouse says my

cousin froze the security camera
on her face.
(beat)
And looked at it for a very long
time.

The two men look at each other across the dying fire.

DESMOND
(beat)
I told you it seemed we had the
same problem.

MARTIN
(very softly)
Tell me about the twins.

HOLD on Martin's face. For the first time all night, he
isn't smiling.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0008

NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

– At 9 AM, CHIEF ELXA JACKSON hands five folders to five commanders. By 10:04, WBKG is running a headline only one of them could have leaked.

– HARMONY opens an envelope from the Fulton County Superior Court: a hearing date and a court-ordered family evaluation. She calls AMOND: "You did this."

– In her office, CARLA MIMS asks the District Attorney four questions. ARIANNA answers every one of them. One of her answers is a lie.

FADE TO BLACK.